time-inconsistency problem becomes more acute in that the BRICS is a group housing a vast power asymmetry between the already "risen" and very large country, China, as compared to the rest (as shown in Chapter 2). In this context, China may use the group during its time of need, but it always possesses the easiest exit option. Hence, the other four BRICS members perhaps discount promises of benefits in the future.

Notwithstanding the time-inconsistency caveat, there has been considerable cooperation among these four (and then five) countries over a number of years. Most of the cases are surprising successes. The only clear failure among these cases is their inability to unite around a new head of the IMF or World Bank in 2011 and 2012, which constitutes one piece of their attempts at inside reforms of the Bretton Woods institutions. Still, even that unsuccessful cooperation resulted in a much more transparent process. When Christine Lagarde wanted to serve a second term, she lobbied the BRICS very hard and was rewarded with their support, especially from the Chinese government following her support for RMB inclusion in the SDR in 2015. The "chairs and shares" cooperation in Case 1 is a belated success and progress is expected to continue. In all the remaining cases—resistance to Western sanctions on Russia (Case 2), the establishment of the NDB and CRA (Case 3), resistance to Western sanctions on Russia (Case 3), and promotion of RMB internationalization (Case 4)—the BRICS' cooperation is ongoing and has strengthened over time. In other words, the BRICS governments have been impressively successful in hanging together despite having diverse political regimes, distinct interests, and even long-standing tensions among some members of this group. Even more striking, there has been remarkable success in achieving the desired outcomes: enhanced voice within the IMF and World Bank, support for Russia and for the principle that financial clout ought not to be employed as a foreign policy tool to violate the sovereignty of other major powers,[177] viable new international financial institutions not controlled by the incumbent Western powers, and RMB internationalization, which is proceeding faster than many observers expected. BRICS cooperation was clearly important for Cases 1, 2, and 3. The BRICS also supported China's case for including the RMB in the SDR (Case 4).

Over the decade of their collaboration, BRICS acquired club properties and successfully coordinated among themselves, while also engaging in repeated instances of bargaining on these cases with the United States and other G7 countries. BRICS bargaining was facilitated in part by the enhanced status of